INCH-POUND

MIL-R-44482
23 September 1994

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

RICE, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers thermostabilized rice in flexible pouches for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat (MRE), Individual.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1).

Types

I - White rice
II - Mexican rice

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8940

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SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Parts 301-399)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001)

U.S. Standards for Milled Rice (7 CFR Part 68)

(Copies are available from the Federal Grain Inspection Service, APHIS, Printing, Distribution, and Mail Section, 6505 Belcrest Road, Room G-100 Federal Building, Hyattsville, MD 20782)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Whole Kernel (Or Whole Grain) Corn
U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Ripe Olives

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)
U.S. Standards of Identity for Margarine (21 CFR Part 166)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, One Maritime Plaza, 23rd Floor, San Francisco, CA 94111.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Rice, long grain, parboiled. Rice shall be parboiled, long grain, milled rice, U.S. No. 2 or better of the U.S. Standards for Milled Rice and be of varieties which are suitable for canning. The rice shall contain not more than 2 percent of kernels having white ungelatinized areas and not less than 10 percent nor more than 15 percent moisture (see 6.3).

3.2.2 Broth/stock, chicken, canned, frozen or dehydrated. The canned (thermostabilized), frozen or dehydrated chicken broth/stock shall be produced from USDA inspected chicken in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The canned, frozen, and dehydrated chicken broth/stock shall be free from extraneous material and cracklings. The chicken broth/stock shall be concentrated to a soluble solids level sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the product in which it is to be used. The broth/stock shall have a characteristic mild-chicken broth/stock odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. The frozen chicken broth/stock shall have been held in storage at $0^{\circ}F$ or below and used in product preparation within 75 days from date of pack. Once thawed, chicken broth/stock shall not be refrozen. The canned chicken broth/stock shall be used in product preparation (see 3.3) within 15 months from date of pack. The packaged dehydrated chicken broth/stock shall be used in product preparation (see 3.3) within 6 months from date of pack.

3.2.3 Corn, whole kernel, individually quick frozen (IQF). The IQF corn kernels shall be U.S. Grade B or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Whole Kernel (Or Whole Grain) Corn. The corn shall have been processed in accordance with 3.3.3.1. The IQF corn kernels shall not have been held in storage for more than 18 months prior to use in product preparation (see 3.3). The packaged IQF corn kernels shall be free flowing from the package and shall show no evidence of thawing and refreezing.

3.2.4 Oil, vegetable. Vegetable oil shall possess a clean, bland flavor and shall have a minimum stability of 25 hours (A.O.M.), a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.05 percent, a moisture/volatile matter content not to exceed 0.06 percent and pass a cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

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3.2.5 Olives, ripe, pitted, sliced, canned. The canned, pitted and sliced ripe olives shall be U.S. Grade C or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Ripe Olives. The canned ripe olives shall not have been held in storage for more than 12 months from date of pack and prior to use in product preparation (see 3.3).

3.2.6 Margarine. Margarine shall be of vegetable origin only and shall conform to the FDA Standards of Identity for Margarine (21 CFR 166.110) and shall possess a fine and pleasing flavor. The body shall be smooth, firm, and homogenous. The margarine shall possess a uniform medium yellow color and may be salted or unsalted.

3.2.7 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. Dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.8 Chili powder. Chili powder shall be a blend of 77 to 82 percent chili pepper; not less than 8.0 percent cumin; not less than 4.0 percent oregano; not less than one percent garlic; and not more than 8.0 percent salt. Anti-caking agents may be included at a level not to exceed 2.0 percent. The chili powder shall have a Scoville Pungency Value of not less than 900 and the moisture content shall not exceed 13.0 percent. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the chili powder shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve.

3.2.9 Peppers, red, sweet, dehydrated. The peppers shall be 3/8 inch dices of sweet red bell peppers which have been air-dried, freeze-dried, or a combination of each. The pepper dices shall possess a fresh, clean, typical sweet red pepper flavor and odor and shall reconstitute to a bright orange-red to dark red color. The dices shall be practically free of seeds, seed cells and diseased or rotted areas. The moisture content shall be not greater than 5 percent.

3.2.10 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.11 Lecithin, powder. Powdered lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Parsley. Parsley shall be a high commercial grade of dried parsley leaves.

3.2.13 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.14 Pepper, red, ground. Ground red pepper shall be derived from red, ripe fruit of Capsicum frutescens L. and shall possess the characteristic yellowish-red to red color. The Scoville Pungency Value shall be not less

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than 30,000 units. The red pepper shall be uniformly ground to allow a minimum of 95 percent, by weight, to pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve, and not less than 95 percent, by weight, to be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 60 sieve.

3.2.15 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner covering have been removed. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.16 Pepper, jalapeno, powder. The jalapeno pepper powder shall be produced from fresh, sound, green jalapenos which are dehydrated, ground, sifted, sorted and graded. The powder must be uniformly ground to allow a minimum of 95 percent, by weight, to pass through a U.S. Standard No. 35 sieve. The powder shall be an olive green color, and have a typical fresh, moderately hot jalapeno aroma and flavor. The moisture of the powder shall not exceed 6 percent (see 6.4).

3.2.17 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, blanching, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.18 Starch, waxy maize, modified, filling and processing aid. The starch shall be a white to off white, odorless, finely pulverized powder suitable for use as a filling and processing aid in thermostabilized foods. The starch shall develop a paste. The initial viscosity of the paste shall be retained under conditions of moderate shear and prolonged holding times. During retorting, the starch shall undergo complete breakdown of the initial viscosity. The starch shall be bland and shall demonstrate easy dispersibility.

3.2.19 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Rice preparation. The rice shall be prepared using the following steps:

NOTE: The blanching process must be carefully controlled in order to meet the finished product moisture content requirement.

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a. For type I product the rice shall be placed in an excess quantity of 190° to 200°F water and blanched until the rice weighs approximately 1.5 times its original dry weight.

b. For type II product the rice shall be placed in an excess quantity of 190° to 200°F water and blanched until the rice weighs approximately 2.5 times its original dry weight.

c. The blanched rice shall be thoroughly rinsed with clean cool water to remove all excess rice starch.

d. The blanched, rinsed rice shall be thoroughly drained

3.3.2 Type I finished product preparation. The type I product shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Rice, blanched	52.8
Water	35.2
Margarine	10.5
Salt 1/	1.2
Lecithin, powder	0.3

a. The margarine shall be completely melted in a manner that prevents margarine burn-on.

b. The lecithin shall be added to and mixed thoroughly with the melted margarine to form a smooth paste.

c. The formulation water and salt shall be added to the margarine/lecithin paste and mixed to form a sauce.

d. The blanched rice shall be mixed thoroughly with the sauce and the final mixture heated to 180°F.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation during heating and holding.

1/ The total amount of salt in the formulation shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

3.3.3 Type II product preparation.

3.3.3.1 Frozen corn preparation. The frozen corn kernels shall not be blanched, but may be thawed/tempered in such a manner that will not cause further degradation of the texture. The thawed/tempered corn kernels shall be handled in such a manner to prevent discoloration.

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3.3.3.2 Type II finished product preparation.

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Rice, blanched	67.85
Broth/stock, chicken, canned, frozen or dehydrated (16 percent solids) 1/	11.86
Water	7.91
Corn	4.50
Oil, vegetable	2.55
Chili powder	1.20
Olives, ripe, pitted, sliced, canned	0.90
Onions, chopped, dehydrated	0.90
Peppers, red, sweet, dehydrated	0.90
Salt 2/	0.80
Lecithin, powder	0.25
Parsley	0.15
Pepper, white, ground	0.07
Garlic powder	0.07
Pepper, jalapeno, powder	0.05
Pepper, red, ground	0.04

a. The vegetable oil and lecithin shall be combined and thoroughly mixed to form a smooth paste.

b. The dehydrated peppers and onions shall be combined with the remaining dry ingredients.

c. The rice, corn and olives shall be combined in a steam jacketed kettle. The oil/lecithin mixture, the dry ingredients, water, and the chicken broth/stock shall be added to the contents of the kettle and shall be thoroughly mixed. The mixture shall be heated to approximately 180° to 190°F stirring constantly.

d. The volume of the finished product shall be adjusted with water prior to filling to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

e. The type II product shall be held in the temperature range of 150° to 180°F at all times prior to filling into pouches. The product shall be filled within 4 hours after cooking.

1/ The chicken broth/stock with different soluble solids content shall be adjusted to the solids specified.

2/ The total amount of salt in the product formula shall be adjusted, as necessary, to produce a product that complies with the finished product requirements (see 3.6).

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3.3.4 Filling and processing aid starch preparation. When a filling and processing aid starch is used, a 1.5 percent solution (slurry) shall be prepared with the starch and part of the formulation water, and the slurry added to the product before final heating.

3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch (see 5.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed in accordance with the pouch filling and sealing requirements specified for class 2 of MIL-P-44073.

b. The temperature of the product at time of sealing shall be 150° to 180°F.

c. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within two hours after sealing.

3.5 Pouch thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved for type I product and 9.6 for type II product. The thermoprocessing operation shall be in compliance with the thermoprocessing requirements for class 2 of MIL-P-44073.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 5.0 ounces.

e. No individual pouch shall contain less than 4.5 ounces of product.

f. Type I rice shall be slightly off-white in color.

g. Type II rice shall be reddish-brown to brown in color.

h. The texture of the rice shall not be hard, mushy, or pasty.

i. The appearance of the rice shall be distinct, uniform rice grains.

j. The finished product shall contain a uniform distribution of ingredients.

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k. The average moisture content of the type I finished product shall be not greater than 63 percent and not less than 58 percent. The average moisture content of the type II finished product shall be not greater than 68 percent and not less than 62 percent.

l. The salt content of the product in any individual pouch shall be not greater than 1.5 percent and not less than 0.5 percent.

m. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding Human Foods", and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material examination. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be examined in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch examination. Examination of the filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight examination. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 4.5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 5.0 ounces.

4.5.5 Product examination. The filled and sealed pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and examined. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The contents shall be examined for the defects indicated in table I.

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TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product examination 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be examined. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Texture of rice is hard, mushy, or pasty
102		Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)
103		Ingredients not uniformly distributed throughout the product
	201	The color of the rice is not characteristic for the specific type
	202	Appearance of rice not distinct, uniform rice grains

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

4.5.6 Salt content testing. Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot. The product shall be tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 935.47 or 971.27 (Method 2), except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened pouches shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent and blended to uniformity in accordance with AOAC, method 920.149(c). The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Moisture content testing. Using the prepared samples from each of three pouches used in salt testing, perform analysis for moisture content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 925.45A. The test should be performed with the addition of sand. Thoroughly incorporate 3-4 grams of washed, ignited sand into 8-10 grams of prepared sample and continue as described in methods 934.06 (paragraph 1) or 925.24(A) to a constant weight ($\leq$ 2 mg). Each sample must be blended to uniformity using a blender or a food processor. The drying time shall be 5-6 hours. The blending must be rapid and conducted in such a way that minimum heat is transferred to the product and that the product has minimum exposure to atmospheric moisture. The results shall be calculated as percent moisture and reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any test result not meeting the requirements of 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.8 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of product required (see 1.2).

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c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
e. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Rice, long grain, parboiled. It has been found that Uncle Ben's Parboiled, Converted Brand Rice, Uncle Ben's Inc., Houston, TX, and Riviana Parboiled (PB-S), Riviana Foods, Inc., Houston, TX, meet the requirements of 3.2.1 and perform satisfactorily in this product.

6.4 Pepper, jalapeno, powder. It has been found that Green Jalapeno Pepper Powder, 35 Mesh, Item #139P-35 manufactured by Cade Grayson Company, 2445 Cades Way, Vista, CA 92083-7898, meets the requirements of 3.2.16 and performs satisfactorily in this product.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational ration
Pasta
Pouch food
Shelf stable

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0778)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-R-44482	940923

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: Rice, Thermostabilized, For Meal, Ready-to-Eat

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial: 508-651-4501	(2) AUTOVON/DSN: 256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WRE Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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